deed I was rather backward and I had only advanced painfully, step by step, where many others had gone ahead blazing a trail. The workers' trade union movement was, ideologically, definitely socialist, and so were the majority of the Youth Leagues. A vague confused socialism was already part of the atmosphere of India when I returned from Europe in December 1927, and even earlier than that there were many individual socialists. Mostly they thought along utopian lines, but Marxian theory was influencing them increasingly, and a few considered themselves as hundred per cent. Marxists. This tendency was strengthened in India, as in Europe and America, by developments in the Soviet Union, and particularly the Five-Year Plan.

Such importance as I possessed as a socialist worker lay in the fact that I happened to be a prominent Congressman holding important Congress offices. There were many other well-known Congressmen who were beginning to think likewise. This was most marked in the U.P. Provincial Congress Committee, and in this Committee we even tried, as early as 1926, to draw up a mild socialist programme. We are a zamindari and taluqadari province, and the first question we had to face was that of the land. We declared that the existing land system must go and that there should be no intermediaries between the State and the cultivator. We had to proceed cautiously, as we were moving in an atmosphere which was, till then, unusued to such ideas.

The next year, 1929, the U.P. Provincial Congress Committee went a step further and made a recommendation, definitely on socialist lines, to the All-India Congress Committee. This latter Committee, meeting in Bombay in the summer of 1929, adopted the preamble of the U.P. resolution and thus accepted the principle of socialism underlying the whole resolution. The consideration of the detailed programme given in the U.P. resolution was postponed for a later date. Most people seem to have forgotten these resolutions of the A.I.C.C. and the U.P.P.C.C. and imagine that the subject of socialism has suddenly cropped up in the Congress during the last year or so. It is true, however, that the A.I.C.C. passed that resolution without giving much thought to it and most members probably did not realise what they were doing.

The U.P. branch of the Independence for India League (consisting entirely of principal Congress workers in the province) was definitely socialistic and it went a little further than a mixed body like the Congress Committee could go. Indeed one of the objects of the Independence League was social freedom. We had hoped to build up a strong League organisation all over India